First Annual Ramstein Ryder Cup

Official Rules, Draft Procedures & Competition Format

Event Dates: September 16–20
Competition Days: September 17–19
Location: Scottsdale, Arizona
Golf Course: Troon North Golf Club
Commissioner: Jason Dousharm
Event Organizer: Daylene Koch

1. Event Purpose and Spirit

The Ramstein Ryder Cup is a team golf competition created to build an annual tradition centered on:

- Competitive but fair play
- Team camaraderie
- Sportsmanship
- Pace of play
- Clear and consistent rules

This is the First Annual Ramstein Ryder Cup. All players are expected to support both the competition and the long-term success of the event.

2. Event Leadership and Authority

Event Leadership

- Commissioner: Jason Dousharm
- Event Organizer: Daylene Koch

Commissioner Authority
The Commissioner has final authority on:

- Player tier classification (A / B / C / D)

- Official rules interpretation
- Final rulings when captains cannot agree
- Final approval of the official rules packet

Event Organizer Role
The Event Organizer supports:

- Event logistics and coordination
- Rules distribution and communication
- Scorecard and standings collection
- Welcome Day and awards presentation logistics
- Ruling coordination support

On-Course Decision Rule

- Each group is responsible for making good-faith rulings in real time
- If a dispute cannot be resolved, play continues and the issue is noted
- Final rulings are handled after the hole or round
- If the Commissioner is involved in a match, they should not act as the sole decision-maker

3. Event Schedule Overview

September 16 – Welcome Day

- Travel and check-in
- Captains announced
- Player tiers confirmed (A / B / C / D)
- Draft order determined
- Player draft conducted
- Women's teams drafted
- Rules review

September 17 – Competition Day 1

- 2 matches' total
- 36 points available

September 18 – Competition Day 2

- 2 matches' total
- 36 points available

September 19 – Competition Day 3

- 3 matches' total
- 54 points available
- Awards presentation

September 20 – Departure

4. Teams and Player Tiers

Each team will consist of 4 golfers:

- 1 A Player
- 1 B Player
- 1 C Player
- 1 D Player

Total: 4 players per team

Women's Teams

- Two women's teams (Team A and Team B) will be drafted on Welcome Day
- Women participate in the Day 1 and Day 2 bonus-point competition

5. Player Tier Classification

Player tiers are assigned by the Commissioner prior to the draft.

Factors may include:

- Skill level
- Recent play
- Consistency
- Competitive balance

Once the draft begins, classifications are final.

6. Captains and Responsibilities

Captains are responsible for:

- Draft participation
- Setting pairings
- Verifying scores

- Managing pace of play
- Resolving minor rules issues

Captains may not change core rules during play.

7. Draft Procedure

- Captains are announced
- Draft order is determined
- Players are drafted
- Women's teams are drafted
- Teams are finalized before competition begins

8. Competition Format and Total Points

Each competition day:

- Day 1: 2 matches (36 points total)
- Day 2: 2 matches (36 points total)
- Day 3: 3 matches (54 points total)

Event total:

- Day 1: 36 points
- Day 2: 36 points
- Day 3: 54 points

Total competition points:

- 126 points

Additional:

- Women's matches award 5 bonus points per day (Day 1 and Day 2 only)
- Bonus points are awarded to the men's team aligned with the winning women's team

Winning Team:

- Team with the most total points wins the Ramstein Ryder Cup

9. Daily Match Formats

Day 1 – 2-Man Scramble (Match Play)

- AB vs AB
- CD vs CD

Day 2 – 2-Man Scramble (Match Play)

- AD vs AD
- BC vs BC

Day 3 – Couples Scramble (Final Day Format)

- 3 matches' total
- 18 points per match
- Pairings determined by captains
- Couples must remain on the same team
- Extra golfers are assigned to balance teams

10. Pairings and Fairness Rules

- No repeat partners
- Pairings rotate by tier:
  Day 1: AB / CD
  Day 2: AD / BC
  Day 3: AC / BD (if possible)
- Each team includes A, B, C, and D players
- Matchups must be like-for-like
- Any exceptions require captain and Commissioner approval

11. Hole-by-Hole Scoring

- Win hole: 1 point
- Tie: 0.5 points
- Loss: 0 points

Each match totals 18 points.

12. Scorekeeping

- Men's matches opposing team keep score
- Women's matches (Day 1 and Day 2): each team keeps their own scrambled score
- Scores must be tracked hole-by-hole
- Final scores must be verified by both sides

13. Women's Competition Format

- Two women's teams (Team A and Team B)
- 3-player scramble format
- Played on Day 1 and Day 2
- Winning team earns 5 bonus points
- Bonus points are awarded to the aligned men's team
- Women's teams switch sides on Day 2

14. Out of Bounds (OB) Rule

- OB is treated as a lateral drop
- 2-stroke penalty applies
- Ball placed near exit point
- No closer to the hole
- Groups make quick decisions to maintain pace

15. Relief Rules

- No special relief system is used
- Players may take relief within one club length
- Relief must not be closer to the hole

16. Tees, Mulligans, and Gimmies

- All players use designated tees
- No mulligans
- No automatic gimmies
- Putts must be holed unless conceded
- Tap-ins may be conceded within the leather

17. Pace of Play

- Keep up with the group ahead
- Be ready to hit
- Limit delays
- Ball search limit: 3 minutes
- Make quick rulings and continue playing

18. Disputes and Rulings

- Attempt to resolve within group
- If unresolved, note and continue
- Commissioner reviews after round
- Scores are final once next hole begins

19. Sportsmanship

- Respect all players and staff
- No cheating or intentional mis-scoring
- Competitive but respectful environment

20. Tiebreaker

If tied after all competition points are completed:

1) Most points won on Day 3
2) Back 9 score
3) Back 6
4) Back 3
5) 18th hole
6) Co-champions or agreed playoff

21. Weather and Adjustments

Captains and Commissioner may:

- Delay play
- Shorten rounds
- Adjust scoring
- Modify format if necessary

22. Absences and Substitutions

- Pairings may be adjusted
- Substitutes allowed with approval
- Replacement players assigned fair tier

23. Awards

- Winning team receives the Ramstein Ryder Cup
- Trophy awarded after Day 3
- Traveling trophy held by winning captain

24. Future Updates

- No mid-round rule changes
- Adjustments made after event
- This serves as the baseline for future events